

SFTP Quick Setup Guide

SFTP Enterprise — Quick Setup Guide

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The fastest path from zero to a working SFTP management API + Web admin. Every command verified against the `sftp-0.1.0-dev-0.1.0` release. No sudo required — everything runs as your unprivileged user (\$11.4.161).

1. Prerequisites

Tool	Min version	Check
Go	1.26	<code>go version</code>
Node.js	22	<code>node --version</code>
SQLite	3.x	<code>sqlite3 --version</code>
Podman (rootless)	5.x	<code>podman --version</code>

2. Clone

```
git clone git@github.com:vasic-digital/sftp.git sftp && cd sftp
git submodule update --init --recursive
```

3. Configure

```
# Copy the template (defaults work for local dev)
cp .env.example .env
chmod 600 .env
```

```
# The only values you MUST set:
```

```
# SUPERADMIN_PASSWORD – your admin password (never committed,  
    never echoed)  
# JWT_SECRET – random 32+ char string (generate: openssl rand  
    -hex 32)  
# Everything else defaults to safe local-dev values
```

4. Build the API

```
cd api && go build -o ../bin/sftp-api ./cmd/sftp-api/ && cd ..  
# Binary lands at bin/sftp-api (git-ignored)
```

5. Start the API

```
# Minimal env – works for local testing  
export SUPERADMIN_PASSWORD="$(grep SUPERADMIN_PASSWORD .env | cut  
    -d= -f2)"  
export JWT_SECRET="$(grep JWT_SECRET .env | cut -d= -f2)"  
export FIREBASE_ENABLED=false
```

```
mkdir -p data/vault  
./bin/sftp-api
```

```
# You should see:  
# sftp-api: super-admin "admin" seeded  
# firebase: disabled  
# sftp-api: listening on 127.0.0.1:7722 (version 0.1.0-dev)
```

6. Health check

```
curl http://127.0.0.1:7722/api/v1/health  
# → {"firebase":"disabled","status":"ok","time":"...","version":"0.1.0-  
    dev"}
```

7. Login as super-admin

```
curl -s -X POST http://127.0.0.1:7722/api/v1/auth/login \  
    -H "Content-Type: application/json" \  
    -d '{"username":"admin","password":"YOUR-SUPERADMIN-PASSWORD"}'
```

```
# → {"access_token":"eyJ...", "refresh_token":"eyJ...", "token_type":"Bearer", "expir
```

Save the token for subsequent calls:

```
TOKEN="$(curl -s ... | python3 -c "import sys,json;
print(json.load(sys.stdin)['access_token'])")"
```

8. Create your first SFTP user

```
curl -s -X POST http://127.0.0.1:7722/api/v1/accounts \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"username":"alice","password":"strongpw","permission":"read_write"}'

# → {"username":"alice","permission":"read_write","home_dir":"/
    alice","enabled":true,...}
```

Permission levels: - read_only — download only - read_write —
upload + download + delete - public — requires
"public_acknowledged":true (explicit opt-in, never default)

9. Sync to SFTP container

```
curl -s -X POST http://127.0.0.1:7722/api/v1/sync \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN"

# → {"path":"data/users.conf","rendered_accounts":1}
```

The data/users.conf file is now ready for the atmoz/sftp container.

10. Start the Web Admin (optional)

```
cd web
npm install
npm run dev
# → http://localhost:5173

# Login with admin / your-superadmin-password
# Dashboard shows all accounts, create/edit/delete from the UI
```

11. Start the SFTP container (with Podman)

```
# Ensure users.conf exists and data directories are ready
podman-compose -f deploy/docker-compose.yml up -d
```

```
# Check status
podman ps --format '{{.Names}} {{.Status}}'
```

12. Verify end-to-end

```
# Create test file
echo "hello sftp" > /tmp/test_upload.txt

# Upload (as alice, port 7721)
sftp -P 7721 alice@127.0.0.1 <<< '$put /tmp/test_upload.txt'

# Download to verify
sftp -P 7721 alice@127.0.0.1 <<< '$get test_upload.txt /tmp/
test_download.txt'
diff /tmp/test_upload.txt /tmp/test_download.txt && echo "E2E
VERIFIED"
```

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
go build fails	cd api && go mod tidy
Port 7722 already in use	ss -tlnp \ grep 7722 — kill the other process
super-admin seeded but login fails	Check SUPERADMIN_PASSWORD matches what you set
public access is never a default	Add "public_acknowledged":true to the request
firebase: disabled in logs	Normal — set FIREBASE_ENABLED=true + provide service account JSON

Sources verified

- atmoz/sftp Docker Hub: <https://hub.docker.com/r/atmoz/sftp>
- Gin framework: <https://gin-gonic.com/docs/>
- Firebase Admin Go SDK: <https://firebase.google.com/docs/reference/admin/go>
- Verified against release sftp-0.1.0-dev-0.1.0 (commit 9047b09)